

The first Chapter.



These are the wordes that Moses spake vnto all Israel on the o-ther syde Jordane in the wilderness, in the playne felde toward the reed see, betwe- ne Paran, Thophel,

Laban, Hazeroth, and Disahab, eleven daies iourney from Horeb, by the waye of mount Seir vnto Cades Bernea. And it fortuneth the first daye of the eleventh moneth in the fortieth yere, that Moses spake vnto y^e chil- dren of Israel accordinge vnto all as y^e LOR- DE commaunded him, * after he had smyt- ten Sihon y^e kynge of the Amorites which dwelt at Hesbon: and Og the kynge of Ba- san, that dwelt at Astaroth, and at Edrei.



On the other syde Jordane in y^e lande of the Moabites, beganne Moses to declare this lawe, and sayde: The LORDE & God spake vnto vs vpon mount Horeb, & sayde: Ye haue bene longe ynough vpon this moun- tayne, turne you, & departed hence, that ye maye come to the mountaynes of the Amo- rites, and to all their neighbours in y^e felde, vpon mountaynes, and in the valleys toward the South and toward the see syde, of the lande of Canaan: and to mount Liba- nus, even vnto the greate water Euphrates. Beholde, I haue deliuered you the londe, go in, and take it in possession, which the LOR- DE swaue vnto y^e fathers, Abraham, Isaac and Jacob, * that he wolde geue it vnto the, and their sede after them.

Gene. 15. d
and 17. b

Exod. 18. c

Then saide I vnto you at the same tyme: I am not able to beare you my self alone, for the LORDE youre God hath increased you, so that this daye ye are as y^e starres of hea- ven in multitude. (The LORDE God of y^e fathers make you yet many thousande ty- mes mo, & blesse you, as he hath promysed you.) How can I alone beare soche cōbraun-

ce, & charge, & stryfe amonge you: prouyde he- re men of wysdome & vnderstandinge, such as are knowne amonge youre trybes, the wil- I set to be heades vnto you.

Then answered ye me, and sayde: It is a good thinge, that thou sayest thou wilt do. Thencoke I y^e heades of youre trybes, wy- se and famous mē, and set them ouer you to be heades, ouer thousandes, ouer hundredes, ouer fiftye and ouer ten: and officers amonge youre trybes.

And I charged youre iudges at y^e same tyme, & sayde: Heare youre brethē, & iudge righteously betwene euery man and his bro- ther, and the stranger. Ye shall knowe no personne in iudgment, but shall heare the small as well as the greate, and be afrayed of no man: for the Iudgment is Gods. But yf eny cause be to harde for you, let it be broughte vnto me, & I maye heare it. Thus commaunded I you at the same tyme, all y^e ye shulde doo.

Then departed we from Horeb, and wal- ked thorow the whole wyldernesse (which is greate and terryble as ye haue sene) by the waye to y^e mountaynes of the Amorites, as the LORDE onre God commaunded vs, and came vnto Cades Bernea. Then sayde I vnto you: Ye are come to y^e mountaynes of y^e Amorites, which the LORDE & God shal geue vs. Beholde, therethe londe before the, which the LORDE thy God hath geue vnto the: Go vp, & conquere it, as y^e LORDE God of thy fathers hath sayde vnto the: * feare not, and be not discouraged.

Then came ye all vnto me, and sayde: Let vs sende men before vs, to spye vs out the londe, and to brynge vs worde agayne, by what waye we shal go vp, and to what ci- ties we shal come. That pleased me well, and I toke twolue men from amonge you, of eu- ry trybe one. Which whan they were depar- ted, and wente vp to hye countre, and ca- me to the ryuer Escol, they spyed it out, and toke of the frute of y^e londe with the, and broughte it downe vnto vs, and broughte vs worde agayne, and sayde: It is a good londe, that the LORDE oure God hath ge- uen vs.

But ye wolde not go vp, and were disho- bedient vnto the mouth of the LORDE you- re God, and murmured in youre tentes, and sayde: Because the LORDE hateth vs, ther- fore hath he broughte vs out of the londe of Egypte, to deliuer vs in to the handes of the Amorites, to destroye vs. Whither shal we go vp? Oure brethē haue discoura- ged

oure hertes, & saide: The people is greater & of hyer stature the we, & cities are greate, & walled euen vp to heauen. Morouer we ha- ue sene there the children of Enakim.

But I sayde vnto you: Feare not, and be not afrayed of them: for the LORDE youre God goeth before you, and shall fighte for you, like as he dealeth with you in Egypte be- fore youre eyes, and in the wyldernesse: whe- re thou sawest, that the LORDE thy God bare the (euen as a man beareth his sonne) thorow out all the waye that ye haue wal- ked, tyll ye came to this place. And yet for all this ye haue not belened on the LORDE youre God, which wente before you, to sear- che you out a place, where ye shulde pitch youre tentes: by night in the fyre (to shewe you the waye, wherin ye shulde go) & on the daye tyme in the cloude.

Whan the LORDE herde y^e voyce of y^e wordes, he was wroth, and swore, and saide: There shall none of this euell generacion se that good londe, which I swaue to geue vnto youre fathers, excepte Caleb the sonne of Jephune, he shal se it. And vnto him wyl I geue the londe that he hath troddē vpon, & to his children, because he hath perfectly so- lowed the LORDE.

The LORDE was angrie wth me also for youre sakes, and sayde: Thou also shalt not go in thither. But Josua y^e sonne of Nun, which stondeth before the, he shal go in thi- ther: Courage him, for he shal deuoyde the en- heritaunce out vnto Israel. And youre chil- drē, of whō ye sayde they shulde be a praye, and youre sonnes which this daie vnderston- de nether good ner bad, they shal go in thi- ther, vnto them wil I geue it, and they shall enioye it. But as for you, turne you, and take youre iourney to the wyldernesse, euen the waye to the reed see.

Then answered ye, & sayde vnto me: We haue synned agaynst y^e LORDE, we wil go vp, and fighte, accordinge to all that the LOR- DE hath commaunded vs. Now whan ye had prepared y^e selues, euery one in his har- nesse, & were at the poynte to go vp to the mountaynes, y^e LORDE sayde vnto me: Spea- ke vnto them, y^e they go not vp, & that they fighte not (for I am not amonge you) that ye be not smytten before youre enemies. Whan I tolde you this, ye wolde not heare, & were disobedient vnto the worde of the LORDE, and were presumptuous, and wente vp to y^e mountaynes. Then the Amorites that dwelt vpon the mountaynes, came out against you, and chased you, as Bees do, and smote you

at Seir, euen vnto Homa. Now whan ye came againe, and wepte before the LORDE, he wolde not heare youre voyce, and encl- ned not his eares vnto you. * So ye abode in Cades a longe season.

The II. Chapter.

Then turned we vs, and toke onre iour- ney to the wilderness, euen the waye to the reed see (as the LORDE sayde vnto me) and compassed mount Seir a longe season. And y^e LORDE saide vnto me: Ye haue compassed this mountayne now longe ynough, turne you Northwarde, and commande the people, and saye: Ye shal go thorow y^e coast- es of youre brethē the children of Esau, which dwell at Seir: & they shal be afrayed of you. But take diligente hede to youre sel- ues, that ye prouoke them not: for I wyl not geue you one fore brethē of their londe. * For mount Seir haue I geuen to the children of Esau to possesse. Ye shal bye meate of them for moneye, that ye maye eate. And water shal ye bye of them for money, that ye maye drynke. For the LORDE thy God hath blef- sed the in all the woikes of thy bondes. He hath considered thy iourneyes thorow this greate wyldernesse: and this fortye yeres hath the LORDE thy God bene with the, so that thou hast wanted nothinge.

Now whan we were departed from o^r brethē the children of Esau, that dwell vpon mount Seir, by the waye of the felde from Elath & Elzeon gaber, we returned vs, & wente by the waye of the wyldernesse of y^e Moabites. Then sayde the LORDE vnto me: * Thou shalt not vex the Moabites, ner prouoke the vnto battayll, for I wil not geue the of their londe to possesse. For Ar haue I geuen vnto the children of Lot in possession. * The Emims dwelt there before tyme, which were a greate stronge people, & hye of stature, as the Enakims: and were taken for giants, like as y^e Enakims. And y^e Moabites called them Emims. * The Ho- rites also dwelt in Seir afore tyme, & y^e chil- dren of Esau droue them out, and destroyed them before them, & dwelt in their steade: li- ke as Israel dyd in y^e lōde of his possession, that the LORDE gaue them.

Get you vp now, & go ouer the ryuer Sa- red. And we wente ouer. The tyme that we were goinge fro Cades Barnea, tyll we ca- me ouer the ryuer Sared, was eight & thir- ty yeres: tyll all the men of warre were waysted out of the hoost, * as the LORDE swaue vnto them. The hande of the LORDE also was agaynst them, to destroye the out

Nu. 20. a

Nu. 21. a

Gen. 35. i

Mal. 1. a

Judic. 3. i

Gen. 14. i

Gen. 26. i

Nu. 24. c

and 26. i